Coup! – Teacher notes

Final Inkscape project for grade 9 (about 45 minutes; the bonus fills a second lesson). Students answer nine questions on the web page – country, movement colour, state name, motto, authoritarian or democratic, a left–right slider, a peace–army slider, what the nation is proud of, number of provinces. The page turns the answers into a banner and writes the Inkscape steps for exactly that banner: exact colour codes (RGBA) and exact sizes (X, Y, W, H) for every shape, all commands from menus or toolbars.

How the answers shape the banner

Answer	Changes	Inkscape skills
Country	palette = the flag colours (curated list, or 'Other country' with colour pickers)	exact colours in Fill and Stroke
Movement colour	which flag colour leads	–
Regime + both sliders	field layout: tricolours, two stripes, Nordic cross, hoist triangle, diagonal band, canton, bordered field	rectangles + exact sizes; Union (cross); Node tool (triangle, band); Intersection (band)
Left – right	emblem frame: ring / disc with outline / shield	Difference / fill and stroke / Union
Peace – army	behind the emblem: sun rays / halo ring / crossed bars	Star tool / stroke only / Transform rotate + Flip + Union
Proud of …	symbol: gear, rising sun, waves, mountains, tree, atom, crown, crescent and star, star outline	Union, Difference, Star and Polygon tools, Transform
Provinces 1–9	number of stars (arc under the emblem or in the canton) with exact positions	Duplicate + typed positions
Authoritarian	name in an arc; motto cut out of a band	Object to Path, Rotate 90°, Put on Path; Object to Path + Difference
Democratic	name straight across the top; motto in a ribbon	text, centring with W; Union + Flow into Frame

With about 85 palettes, 18 layout cells, 9 symbols, 9 star counts and free text, practically every student gets a different banner. Every banner uses shapes with exact sizes, exact colours, at least one path operation, regular text and either Put on Path or Flow into Frame; many also use the Node tool, Intersection and Transform.

Classroom notes

- The framing is a fictional, tongue-in-cheek coup (the page says so); nothing in the task is about real politics or violence – the country only supplies the colour palette. The built-in list leaves out countries currently at war or in acute crisis; 'Other country' with colour pickers still lets anyone use any country. Edit the COUNTRIES list in inkscape/final/coup.js to add or remove countries.
- Students should lock in their banner before Inkscape. Changing answers later clears the ticks, because the steps change.
- Progress is saved in the browser (like the other missions); the landing page shows it. 'Print my plan' prints the personal steps.
- Inkscape 1.x: Y is measured from the top of the page; the X, Y, W, H fields include the stroke – shapes without stroke match exactly.
- The curved name: circle → Path ▸ Object to Path → Object ▸ Rotate 90° CW twice, then Put on Path – the text then starts at 9 o'clock and runs over the top (tested in Inkscape 1.4).

Assessment (10 points)

Element	Points
Field: correct layout, size 300 × 180, exact colours	2
Behind the emblem + frame (correct operation)	2
Symbol built with the given path operations	2
Stars in the right number and place	1
Name (arc with Put on Path, or centred) and motto (cut-out or flowed)	2
Frame; SVG + PNG handed in with the correct names	1

Twelve banners from twelve sets of answers



Brazil · democratic · left · peace · industry · 1



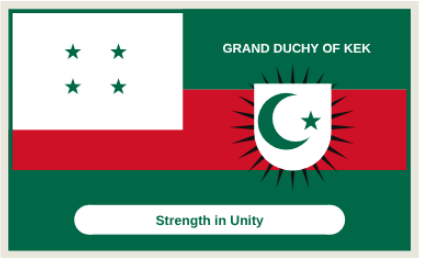
Japan · authoritarian · left · peace · forests · 4



Germany · democratic · centre · peace · freedom · 7



Sweden · authoritarian · centre · peace · mountains · 1



Mexico · democratic · right · peace · night · 4



Ghana · authoritarian · right · peace · sea · 7



Greece · democratic · left · balanced · kings · 1



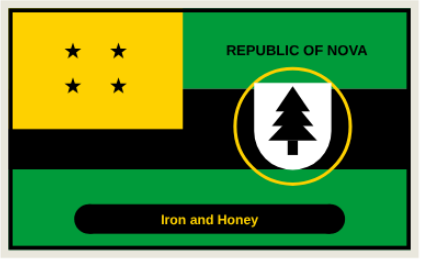
India · authoritarian · left · balanced · farming · 4



Canada · democratic · centre · balanced · science · 7



Peru · authoritarian · centre · balanced · industry · 1



Jamaica · democratic · right · balanced · forests · 4



Mongolia · authoritarian · right · balanced · freedom · 7

Country · regime · left/centre/right · peace/balanced/army · proud of · provinces